

HEEJUN KIM

 [Homepage](#)  [Email](#)  [GitHub](#)  [Google Scholar](#)

EDUCATION

Gwangju Institute of Science and Technology (GIST)

February 2020 - present

B.S Major: Electrical Engineering and Computer Science, GPA 4.21/4.50

Location: Gwangju, South Korea

University of California, Berkeley (UC Berkeley)

June 2024 - August 2024

Summer Session, GPA 4.0/4.0

Coursework: Introduction to Artificial Intelligence, Principles & Techniques of Data Science

RESEARCH EXPERIMENTS

Learning and Adaptation Algorithm Lab

January 2026 - present

Research Assistant, Seoul National University

Seoul, South Korea

- Supervised by [Prof. Taesup Kim](#)
- Conducting research on Agentic Memory Using LLM Uncertainty Estimation

Data Science Lab

Feb 2025 - present, January 2024 - June 2024

Research Assistant, Gwangju Institute of Science and Technology

Gwangju, South Korea

- Supervised by [Prof. Sundong Kim](#)
- Developed an architecture applying generative models to reinforcement learning for solving the Abstract Reasoning Corpus (ARC).
- Researched test-time adaptation with reinforcement learning for self-improving reasoning capabilities of large language model

Forschungszentrum Jülich

September 2024 - February 2025

Korea-Germany Junior Research Fellowship Program 2024

Jülich, Germany

- Host Institute: INM-7 directed by [Prof. Simon B. Eickhoff](#) and contributed to Mathematical Neuroscience Group led by [Dr. Oleksandr Popovych](#).
- Developed preprocessing pipeline for multi-modal MRI human connectome data using HPC and HyperThreading (Project Supervisor: [Dr. Kyesam Jung](#))
- Fund: 12,000,000KRW (8,197EUR) by National Research Foundation of Korea (NRF)(No. RS-2023-00254343).

PUBLICATIONS

From Noise to Diversity: Random Embedding Injection in LLM Reasoning

Heejun Kim, Seungpil Lee, Jewon Yeom, Jaewon Sok, Seonghyeon Park, Jeongjae Park, Taesup Kim, Sundong Kim
[Under Review] *ICML 2026 Mechanistic Interpretability Workshop (Spotlight, 2.8% acceptance rate)*. [\[Paper\]](#)

Hallucination as Commitment Failure: Larger LLMs Misfire Despite Knowing the Answer

Jewon Yeom, Jaewon Sok, Heejun Kim, Seonghyeon Park, Jeongjae Park, Taesup Kim
[Under Review] *ICML 2026 Mechanistic Interpretability Workshop (Poster)*. [\[Paper\]](#)

On the Role of Proposal Support in Diffusion-Based Offline RL for Sequential Decision-Making

Yunho Kim, Jaehyun Park, Heejun Kim, Sejin Kim, Byung-Jun Lee, Sundong Kim
[Under Review] *ICML 2026 DEMO Workshop (Poster)*.

Disentangling Question, Response, and Verifier Languages in Multilingual LLM Evaluation

Jewon Yeom, Jaewon Sok, Seonghyeon Park, [Heejun Kim](#), Jeongjae Park, Taesup Kim
[Under Review]

On the Tip of the Tongue: First-Token Cueing as a Behavioral Probe of Recall in LLMs

Jaewon Sok, Jewon Yeom, [Heejun Kim](#), Seonghyeon Park, Jeongjae Park, Taesup Kim
[Under Review]

Efficient Epistemic Uncertainty Estimation for Large Language Models via Knowledge Distillation

Seonghyeon Park, Jewon Yeom, Jaewon Sok, Jeongjae Park, Heejun Kim, Taesup Kim

[Under Review] [[Paper](#)]

PROJECTS

Skill-based Reinforcement Learning with UCB Skill Selection

May 2025 - June 2025

- Reproduced BeCL framework for unsupervised skill discovery in reinforcement learning environments
- Developed Multi-Armed Bandit approach with UCB algorithm to improve downstream task adaptation efficiency. [[Poster](#)]

Hyundai AI Challenge

September 2023 - October 2023

- Processed large-scale port logistics datasets (cleaning, feature extraction, temporal aggregation).
- Built tree-based boosting models to predict ship waiting times.
- Ranked Top 25/330 teams among 1,300+ participants.

LEADERSHIPS

Teaching Assistant

Fall 2025

- Machine Learning & Deep Learning (AI5213/EC4213): led TA sessions, held office hours, managed assignments/exams, and organized Kaggle competition. [[Homepage](#)]

Korea Army Instructor

February 2021 - August 2022

- Served as an Army instructor in the 50th Division in Daegu, South Korea
- Conducted basic training for approximately 2000 military personnel

EXTRA ACTIVITIES

Google Developer Student Club

September 2023 - February 2024

- Participated in an AI study focused on machine learning and deep learning
- Studied models in ML/DL and analysis of top team models in Kaggle AI competitions
- Established study directions and organized study materials as a team leader

Financial Investment Conference

March 2023 - March 2024

- Conducted a study on economics
- Analyzed and presented economic markets on a weekly basis

GIST Club Federation

February 2020 - December 2020

- Managed clubs in Gwangju Institute of Science and Technology

SKILLS

Programming Languages

Python, C/C++

Python Packages & Framework

PyTorch, VeRL, Scikit-learn, Pandas, Numpy, Matplotlib, Ray

Operating System

Linux, Windows, MacOS

Others

Docker, Wandb, SLURM, HTCondor, SQLite

HONORS

Government Scholarship, Gwangju Institute of Science and Technology

2020 - present

Government Scholarship, STEM scholarship

2020 - present

Dean's List, College of Information and Computing, GIST

Spring 2025, Fall 2025

GIST International Internship Support Program

September 2024 - February 2025

Korea-Germany Junior Research Fellowship Program 2024

September 2024 - February 2025

- Organized by the Max Planck POSTECH/KOREA Research (MPK)